

Postdoctoral Award: assessment criteria



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How will the funding committee assess your Postdoctoral Award application?

The funding committees for the Postdoctoral Award will assess your application based on these assessment criteria:

Applicant

As the applicant, you should:

- demonstrate relevant research experience or training that supports the research described in your application.
- provide evidence of high-quality, impactful research outputs relevant to your career stage and background.
- demonstrate that you are on a trajectory to become a future health/social care research leader
- if you are an early-career postdoctoral applicant or transitioning into applied health/social care research, you should provide evidence of commitment to a career as a researcher in applied health or social care research
- for more experienced postdoctoral applicants; you should provide evidence of independence or starting to establish independence as a researcher, including establishing collaborations and building research capacity

Proposed Research

The details of your proposed research that you provide in your application will be assessed based on the:

- quality of the plain English summary
- quality, scope and relevance of the review of existing evidence
- suitability of the proposed research programme to your experience and scope of funding
- quality of your research design and its suitability to answer the research question(s) being posed
- likely impact of the research to patients/service users, carers, the public and health and/or care services
- evidence of appropriate and meaningful work with people and communities
- justification for the level of support requested (both in terms of the award's cost and duration)
- quality of your inclusive research design and how inclusivity has been considered across the research lifecycle.

Training and Development

Your training and development plan will be assessed based on:

- quality and relevance of the training and development plan proposed
- suitability of the proposed training to your personal development needs and that of the project
- the extent to which your proposed training, and if applicable, any salaried professional practice time, supports your career aspirations.

Site(s) and Support

The details of your site(s) and support that you provide in your application will be assessed based on the:

- track record of the contracting organisation (and partner organisations where appropriate) in the research area being proposed

- suitability of the research support and mentorship arrangements proposed
- appropriateness of the contracting organisation (and partner organisations where proposed) to support the award and your career aspirations
- evidence of the contracting organisation's (and partner where appropriate) commitment to creating and maintaining an inclusive and supportive research culture, including evidence of commitment to the principles of research inclusion and research integrity.

More information and contact

- **Postdoctoral Award: our committees** (<https://www.nihr.ac.uk/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award/committees>)
- **Postdoctoral Award: overview** (<https://www.nihr.ac.uk/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award>)

Contact us

Contact us if you have questions about the programme. Raise issues about completing a funding application online through our awards management system.

Telephone: [0113 532 8444 \(tel:01135328444\)](tel:01135328444)

Email: [personal.awards+poda@nihr.ac.uk \(mailto:personal.awards+poda@nihr.ac.uk\)](mailto:personal.awards+poda@nihr.ac.uk)